INCH-POUND

A-A-886B
December 9, 2022
SUPERSEDING
A-A-886A
November 5, 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TOWELS, BATH (TERRY)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description (CID) by all federal agencies as a replacement for DDD-T-551K.

1. SCOPE. This commercial item description covers the requirements for Type I single loop terry cloth towel for all the Services and Federal agencies and Type II double loop terry cloth towel for Federal agencies.

2. CLASSIFICATION. The towels shall be of the following types, classes, and styles:

2.1 Types and classes.

Type I - Single loop (pile yarns woven singly)

Class 1 – 20 by 40 inches
Class 2 – 22 by 44 inches
Class 3 – 16 by 27 inches
Class 4 – 24 by 50 inches

Type II - Double loop (pile yarns woven as one)

Class 1 – 22 by 44 inches
Class 2 – 16 by 27 inches
Class 3 – Deleted
Class 4 – 20 by 40 inches

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FSC 7210

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2.2 Styles.

Style A - Selvage edge both sides
Style B - One selvage edge, one hemmed edge
Style C - Hemmed edge both sides

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Description. The cotton terry cloth towels shall be single loop for Type I and double loop for Type II with selvage edge on both sides, or one (1) selvage edge, one (1) hemmed edge, or hemmed edge on both sides. The borders shall be woven without any terry loops for both types. The towels shall be woven without any designs. If a woven design (nonmilitary) is required, it shall be as specified in (7.6).

3.2 Materials.

3.2.1 Basic material. The material for cotton terry cloth towels shall be as specified in Table I and II.

3.2.2 Weave. The cloth shall consist of warp and filling ground yarns and warp pile yarns, woven with a terry weave, except that:

a. There shall be a border woven without terry loops, 1 to 2-1/2 (± 1/2) inches wide, at each end of each towel. The measured width of the border shall include the width of the hem, or
b. There shall be a border woven without terry loops, 1 to 2-1/2 (± 1/2) inches wide, placed 3-1/2 (± 1/2) inches from the hem on each end of the towel.
c. A woven border at the end hem, up to 3/4-inch wide is permissible.

3.2.2.1 Selvage for Styles A and B. The weave for the selvages shall be a 3 by 3 rib weave (two (2) ends weaving as one (1)) or a terry weave selvage. Each selvage shall be 1/4 - 3/8 inches wide.

3.2.3 Color. The color shall be bleached white or dyed as specified in the contract or procurement documents. The finished cloth shall match the standard sample for shade and appearance and shall be equal to or better than the standard sample with respect to all characteristics for which the standard sample is referenced.

3.2.3.1 Visual shade matching. The color and appearance of the towel shall match the standard sample when viewed using the AATCC EP 9, Option C, (see 7.4.1) with a primary light source simulating the spectral quality of average daylight, CIE Illuminant D65, with a color temperature of 6500 (± 200) Kelvin (K) illumination of 100 (± 20) foot candles. Alternatively, the color and appearance of the towel shall match the standard sample with a primary light source simulating artificial daylight, CIE Illuminant D75, with a color temperature of 7500K (± 200) illumination of 100 (± 20) foot candles in lieu of D65, (see 7.4.2). The towel shall also be a good match to the standard sample with a secondary source simulating the spectral quality of incandescent lamplight, CIE Illuminant A, with a color temperature of 2856K (± 200).

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TABLE I. Physical and colorfastness requirements.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Fiber content: Ground warp and filling all types and classes (except for Type I, 24 x 50-inch towel) Pile warp yarns (all types) Type I, 24 x 50-inch towel	100 % Cotton or polyester/cotton 1/ 100 % cotton 100% cotton	AATCC TM20A (see 7.5)
Weave	See 3.2.2	Visual 2/
Selvage	See 3.2.2.1	Visual
Colorfastness, grade (min.): - Light (after 20 AFU or 85 kJ/(m^2nm)@420nm) - Laundering, (3 cycles)	 3.5 3.5	 AATCC TM16.3, Opt 3, 3/ AATCC TM61, Test 4A 4/, 5/
Crimp in terry yarns, percent (min.)	235	ASTM D3883 6/
Dimensional change, percent (max.) Warp Filling	 10 2	 AATCC TM 135 ,(1),(V),(Aiii)
pH	5.0 - 8.5	AATCC TM81
Toxicity	3.5	3.5.1

1/ Polyester content not to exceed 70 percent. The remaining shall be cotton.
2/ One determination shall be made from each sample unit and the results reported as "pass" or "fail.".
3/ Rated using the AATCC EP1, Evaluation Procedure for Gray Scale for Color Change.
4/ The specimen must be dried after each of the three (3) laundering cycles.
5/ Rated using the AATCC EP1, Evaluation Procedure for Gray Scale for Color Change and AATCC EP2, Evaluation Procedure for Gray Scale for Staining
6/ ASTM D3883 shall be followed except for the following:
a. The original length shall be 2-inches in lieu of 10-inches in the test procedure.
b. The Jaw distance shall be set at 2-inches apart in lieu of 10-inches.
c. Calculation of results shall be based on a 2-inch length in lieu of 10-inches.

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TABLE II. Physical requirements.

Type	Class	Yarns per inch (min.) ASTM D3775		Breaking strength, pounds (min.) ASTM D5034		Weight per dozen, pounds (min.) 2/ Calibrated scale	Dimensions (finished), inches Calibrated ruler	
		Warp	Filling	Warp	Filling		Width tolerance (± 1/2) inch 3/	Length tolerance (± 1.0) inch
I	1	1/	29	60	55	5.5	20	40
I	2	1/	29	60	55	6.6	22	44
I	3	1/	29	60	55	3.0	16	27
I	4	1/	29	60	43	8.0	24	50
II	1	84	42	45	40	8.5	22	44
II	2	84	42	45	40	3.0	16	27
II	3	71	29	45	40	5.5	20	40

1/ For Type I towels, the pile warp shall be 36 and the ground warp shall be 36.
2/ Towels shall reach equilibrium under Standard Conditions as defined in ASTM D1776 prior to determination of weight.
3/ With inclusive of selvages or side hems.

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3.2.4 Labile sulfur. The use of dyes and compounds containing sulfur capable of oxidation to sulfuric acid is prohibited. The cloth shall be "Free" of labile sulfur when tested as specified in 3.2.4.1.

3.2.4.1 Presence of labile sulfur test. Two (2) 1.50 (± 0.01) gram samples from each sample unit shall be tested. Each of the two (2) samples shall be cut into very small pieces and placed into separate test tubes. Prepare an acidic tin(II) chloride (stannous chloride) solution by dissolving 100 g $SnCl_2$ (ACS grade) in 100 mL of 35% hydrochloric acid (ACS grade) and adding the mixture to 50 mL of distilled water. Prepare a lead acetate solution by dissolving 5.0 g of lead acetate (CP reagent grade) in a small amount of distilled water and diluting to a total of 100 mL. If the solution is not clear, add a few drops (one at a time) of glacial acetic acid until the solution is clear. The samples shall be submersed the acidic tin(II) chloride solution. A filter paper wet out with the lead acetate solution shall be placed over the top of the test tube. The test tube containing the textile sample, tin(II) chloride and wet filter paper shall be heated over a low flame until the solution is boiling. The solution should not be heated for more than 15 seconds. A brown to black stain on the filter paper should be evaluated as follows:

Free - The filter paper shows no discoloration or staining of any kind.
Slight - The filter paper shows a light tan to light brown discoloration stain.
Moderate - The filter paper shows a dark brown discoloration stain.
Severe - The filter paper shows a black color stain.

The rating shall be recorded. The results shall be recorded as "pass" or "fail.

3.3 Thread. The thread for hemming shall conform to the requirements of A-A-52094. The thread size for end hems shall be Tex. 50, 3-ply or Tex. 40, 3-ply. The thread sizes for the side hem (styles B and C only) shall be Tex. 40, 3-ply for the needle thread and Tex. 30, 2-ply or Tex. 40, 3-ply for the looper thread. The color of the thread shall match the color of the towel. A textured nylon thread having a breaking strength of four (4) pounds minimum (ASTM D2256) and 10,000 yards per pound minimum (ASTM D1907) may be used as an alternate thread for the 401stitch type. The color of the thread shall match the color of the towel (see 3.2.2).

3.3.1 Stitches, seams, and stitching. Stitches shall be executed as per Table III and IV.

TABLE III. End hems.

Stitch type	Hem width	Stitching from turned edges (inches)	Stitches per inch	Seam type
301 or 401 1/, 2/	1/4 to 3/8	1/16 to 1/8	8 - 12	EFb-1 3/

1/ The hem sewn with the 301 stitch type shall be backstitched at least 1/2-inch, at the beginning and ends of the stitching.
2/ For the 401 stitch type, a stitching chain 1/4 to 1/2-inch length shall be left at the first and last ends of the stitching or the stitches for the first and last 1/4-inch may be gathered at the rate of 14 - 16 stitches per inch.
3/ Seam type in accordance with ASTM D6193.

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TABLE IV. Side hems.

	Sides with plain border	Width of border (inches)	Seam type	Hem width (inches)	Stitching margin (inches)	Stitch type	Stitches per inch
Style B	1	3/4	EFb-1	1/4 to 3/8	3/16 to 1/4	301 or 401	8 -10
Style C	2	3/4	EFb-1	1/4 to 3/8	3/16 to 1/4	301 or 401	8 -10

3.4 Label. Each towel shall have a label in accordance with Type VI, Class 1 and Class 3 of MIL-DTL-32075. When specified, each towel shall be marked with "US" in 1-inch block letters in a black medium to be centered in the border on one end of the towel. The "US" marking shall conform to Type IV, Class 9 of MIL-DTL 32075.

3.4.1 Barcode hang tag. Each towel shall have a barcode label/hangtag conforming to Type VIII, Class 17 of MIL-DTL-32075. The barcoding element shall be a 13-digit National Stock Number (NSN). There shall be a 12-digit Universal Product Code (UPC) number assigned for all NSNs by the contracting activity. The initials “UPC” must appear beneath the code. The barcode for NSN and UPC type shall be a medium to high density and shall be located so that it is completely visible on the towel when it is folded and/or packaged as specified and so it causes no damage to the towel.

3.5 Toxicity. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or procurement documents, the finished towel shall not present a health hazard and shall show compatibility with prolonged, direct skin contact when tested as specified in 3.5.1.

3.5.1 Toxicity test. When the toxicity requirement (see 3.5) can be demonstrated with historical use data, on the finishing treatments used, toxicity testing may not be required (see 7.1.4 and 7.5).

3.6 Workmanship. The finished towel shall conform to the quality of the product established in this document. The towel shall be free from defects which would affect its serviceability, appearance, uniformity, and quality assurance standards defined by the technical data in the procurement documents.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. Unless otherwise specified, the offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered, recycled, bio based, and environmentally preferable materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403, 23.404(b) of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR), or the sustainable acquisition of EO 13693; as applicable (see 7.1.2).

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5. PRODUCT CONFORMANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product conformance. The towel shall meet the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Market acceptability. The finished towel offered must have been sold to the government or commercial market.

5.3 End item inspection procedures. Sampling for inspection shall be conducted in accordance with ASQ/ANSI Z1.4 – Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection of Attributes (see 7.2.2).

5.4 Visual examination. Each finished towel shall be examined for the defects listed in Table V as defined in ASTM D3990. The lot size shall be expressed in units of towels. The sample unit shall be one (1) towel.

TABLE V. Visual examination defects.

Material defects: Any hole, cut, tear, permanent fold, pleat, or crease; any spot or stain on outside, discoloration or color not as specified, any outwardly visible part shaded, any serious material defects, design omitted or objectionable odor. Broken or missing ground warp or filling yarn. Fine or light filling barre, light place. Wrong draw or reed mark. Selvage missing, cut torn, scalloped, torn, rolled, or folded. Terry loops missing in combined directions or not formed properly, terry pile caught inside hem. Any trash, motes, leaf, or seed coat fragments.
Stitches, seams, and stitching: Wrong seam or stitch type; loose or tight stitching tension, broken or skipped stitches, needle chew, any part caught in an unrelated operation or stitching, raw edge, thread ends not removed, any seam slippage, re-stitching, pleating, or puckering; distorted, open, pulled, or snagged stitches, twisted, ragged or inconsistent edge. Backstitching at the hem omitted for 301 stitching. End of hem stitching not secured as specified for 401 stitching. Hem omitted at end of towel, hem twisted, pleated, or puckered. Hem width not as specified. Width of side hem or selvage not as specified. Thread color not as specified.
Workmanship: Any component part omitted, twisted, not specified size, missing, misplaced or distorted parts; poorly shaped, any dimension of item not as specified; design not as specified. Failure to meet product conformance; serviceability, reliability and quality of materials as defined by this document. Design omitted, incomplete, illegible, incorrect, wrong color or misplaced.
Labels: Label(s) missing, incorrect, or illegible; "US" marking omitted, illegible, incorrect, wrong color.
Packaging: Not packaged in accordance with the contract or procurement documents.

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5.5 Dimensional examination. The finished towel shall conform to the dimensions specified in Table II, when measured as stated. Any dimension that is not within the established tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The sample unit shall be one (1) towel.

5.6 Acceptance criteria. Acceptance criteria shall be as specified in the contract or procurement documents (see 7.6).

6 PACKAGING. The preservation, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or procurement documents (see 7.6).

7 NOTES.

7.1 Source of Government documents:

7.1.1 Copies of Government documents are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil.

7.1.2 EPA and EO 13693 information are available online at https://www.epa.gov.

7.1.3 Federal Acquisition Regulations (FAR) are available online at https://acquisition.gov.

7.1.4 Toxicity testing. If dermal toxicity testing is required, it will be conducted using Title 40, Protection of Environment, Code of Federal Regulations current edition and applicable sections, which are also consistent with the following OECD tests:

Skin Sensitization 406 and Dermal Irritation 404 (https://www.oecd-ilibrary.org/environment/oecd-guidelines-for-the-testing-of-chemicals-section-4-health-effects_20745788?page=1).

Dermal Sensitization (https://www.law.cornell.edu/cfr/text/40/798.4100)
Dermal Toxicity (https://www.law.cornell.edu/cfr/text/40/798.2250)

7.2 Source of non-Government documents.

7.2.1 AATCC Test Methods and Evaluation Procedures are available for purchase online at https://www.aatcc.org.

7.2.2 ASQ/ANSI Z1.4 – Sampling Procedures are available online at https://asq.org.

7.2.3 ASTM Standards are available for purchase online at https://www.astm.org.

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7.3 Intended use.

a. Type I, Class 1 and 4 towel is intended for use by all Military services and Federal agencies.

b. Type I, Classes 2, 3, and Type II, Classes 1, 2, and 4 towels are intended for use by Federal Agencies.

7.4 Standard samples. For access to standard shade samples of cloth, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids or request for proposal.

7.4.1 Visual shade matching. In 2017, Option A of AATCC EP9 was changed to Option C. NOTE: In case of confusion, the viewing geometry should be "The specimen plane and illumination source will be parallel to each other and aligned so that the light flux is incident at the center of the specimen plane, which is set at a 35 (± 5º) angle relative to the horizontal. The observer will view the specimens at a 90º angle, relative to the plane of the specimens".

7.4.2 In 2022, the U.S. Military (All Services) accepted D65 as the new preferred light source for visual shade matching due to the supply chain issues with D75.

7.5 Certificate of compliance. The contracting activity may select to accept a certificate of compliance for a stated requirement.

7.6 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
b. Type, class, and style required (see 2.1 and 2.2).
c. When woven design is required (see 3.1)
d. Color required (see 3.2.3).
e. When marking is required (see 3.4)
f. When toxicity testing is required (see 3.5).
g. Product conformance (see 5.1).
h. Acceptance criteria (see 5.6).
i. Packaging requirements (see 6.).

7.7 National Stock Number (NSNs). The following is a list of NSNs assigned that correspond to this CID. This list may not be indicative of all possible NSNs associated with the CID and are provided for reference only.

NSN	Type	Class and Style	Color
7210-01-125-2594	I	Class 1, Style A, B, or C	Brown 436
7210-01-286-0983	I	Class 4, Style A or B	Bleached white
7210-01-598-0225	I	Class 4, Style A	Brown 436

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7.8 Key words.

Cloth
Cotton
Polyester

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:
Army - GL
Navy - NU
Air Force - 11

Review activities:
Army - MD
Navy - CG, MC

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTVITY:
GSA-FAS

Preparing Activity
DLA-CT

(Project: 7210-2023-001)

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